MONTHLY UPDATE

New investments: monthly update, August 2026

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22 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CHAD · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GHANA · KENYA · MALAWI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · MOZAMBIQUE · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Benin

One commitment entered the window. During a ministerial visit of 4 to 6 August, Canada announced CAD5m for the digital transformation of women-led businesses, one of seven projects in a package of about CAD17m for Benin and West Africa. The remaining six lines are outside the digital estate. What the digital line does not carry is an implementing partner, a start date or a duration, so there is nothing yet to follow from the announcement to a system.

Burkina Faso

The regional development bank's Digital Transformation Fund was presented to public administrations on 18 and 19 August, with its programme site and eligibility terms published. No allocation to this country, application window or committed amount is stated.

Cameroon

What deters investment was named out loud. At a United States-convened business climate forum in Yaoundé, financial technology and foreign-exchange rules rather than the investment case dominated the discussion, and a separate assessment set out what is still getting in the way of United States digital investment despite strong demand. Demand is not the constraint here and both accounts say so; the record held carries no rule changed in response.

Chad

The digital transformation project shows US$12,220,932 disbursed and three thousand electronic payment terminals handed to the finance ministry, with about 500 unserved localities named as the outstanding challenge. Its envelope is carried as FCFA 76.45bn in one source and US$92.2m in another — the first close to total project cost, the second to the grant alone — and no source reconciles them. A further programme of about FCFA 8bn sits at pipeline stage, 90 per cent externally committed with a closing date of 31 January 2029, covering electronic tax, standardised electronic invoicing, customs upgrades, tax teleservice centres and one-stop-shop interconnection. It is an aid-transparency record, not a signed instrument.

The fund's own appraisal report now settles the amount the base could not reconcile: the grant is UA 9.52m against a phase-one total cost of UA 10.535m, so the FCFA figure the base had been carrying was a reporting outlet's conversion, and the gap between the two is the rest of the financing plan rather than a discrepancy.

Congo

A number was put on the sector's future. Consultancy forecasts reported by the state news agency attribute more than 800 billion of gross domestic product to the digital economy within five years. It is a projection carried by the state agency, not a measurement, and the record held carries no current figure for the sector's contribution against which to read it.

Cote d'Ivoire

The month's one new financing commitment is large and thinly documented. The government has authorised a United States technology firm to carry out a set of projects strengthening national digital infrastructure, the whole estimated at US$170m, about FCFA 95bn. No signed contract, financing instrument, component list, timetable or procurement route is held for it, and it sits beside the same firm's US$170m data-centre and border-surveillance package announced from Washington in July, which the record does not distinguish from it.

The African Development Bank's e-government programme is meanwhile the route by which several of the ministry's digital projects reach the market, through open tenders and calls for expressions of interest, with the winners of the two 30-company support programmes among the intended bidders. No award, value or project list is published.

DR Congo

A development fund committed US$32.8m into an upsized US$179m senior secured facility on 5 August, funding 728 new passive towers to take the network to 1,800, 70% of them rural, with solar and battery upgrades. The same lender committed US$30m to the same borrower in 2023, when the network stood at 1,072 active towers.

Egypt

The data-centre position moved by cancellation. Telecom Egypt's board withdrew on 17 July from the agreement to sell 75-80% of its Regional Data Center Hub because the conditions were not met; the hub is instead to be carved out as a wholly-owned subsidiary (cancellation account). Neither the consideration nor the unmet conditions were disclosed.

Eswatini

A domestic internet provider put E570,000 into free wireless access across the nine-day national trade fair, its third consecutive year as official sponsor. It is the month's only new private digital commitment on this ledger, and it is a sponsorship rather than an investment.

Ethiopia

The month's finance entry is an allegation rather than a commitment. Corruption allegations against a donor-funded digital project were raised in the German federal parliament. No project name, amount, Ethiopian response or investigation outcome is on the record held, so what the base carries is that the question has been asked in a donor's own legislature.

Ghana

Two new commitments enter the base this month, one domestic and one from a development partner. The government put GH¢100 million, about US$8.88 million, behind the Ghana National Research Fund for 2026, separately from its US$250 million commitment to a national artificial-intelligence computing centre; no disbursement or call for proposals is reported against the allocation. The UN capital development fund began a second phase with a Ghanaian microcredit company on a US$200,000 grant it expects to catalyse US$1 million in loans and savings, after a first phase on US$30,000 that reached 470 enterprises across three regions and recorded 1,988 youth loans totalling GHS494,760.

Kenya

Two financings were signed. A EUR270m facility across 21 obligors in eight jurisdictions was signed on 9 July, its committed portion of up to EUR170m including a local-currency tranche of up to EUR20m equivalent in shillings for fibre modernisation in Kenya, with a further uncommitted EUR100m for future acquisitions and capital expenditure across the lender's sub-Saharan operations. Domestically the digital economy acceleration project took KSh 4.3bn for the year, half the entire digital thematic, to equip more than 10,000 junior secondary schools.

On 4 August the development lender committed US$24.2m across three Kenyan lenders under the first catalytic first-loss guarantee transactions anywhere in Africa, backed by US$11m of concessional private-sector-window money and expected to catalyse about US$144.4m of local-currency lending to micro-enterprises. Only one of the three counterparties is a digital lender; the individual allocations are not disclosed, so what the structure buys in fintech terms cannot be read off the announcement.

On the lending side, a guarantee structure was announced on 5 August: a catalytic first-loss guarantee of US$24.2m across three Kenyan transactions, backed by US$11m of concessional financing, expected to catalyse about US$144.4m of local-currency lending to small and medium enterprises. The catalysed figure is an expectation rather than a disbursement. One of the three counterparties reports having disbursed more than US$1bn cumulatively over thirteen years to micro and small businesses without collateral or financial records, underwriting on its own model rather than credit files — a lifetime total given in a profile, with no outstanding book, default rate or borrower count beside it.

Malawi

The largest digital programme on the books came under review. The World Bank opened a five-day implementation support mission on Malawi's US$150 million Digital Acceleration Project. Against it sits an estimate of what the reform agenda is worth: about 1.1 trillion kwacha, some US$634 million, in economic value projected from targeted digital reforms. A projection and a mission are not results; the record held carries no disbursement figure and no delivered output against either. A consultation in Blantyre on 3 September then put the project's second phase at US$35 million to US$75 million over a six-year implementation, covering more than 500 public-sector institutions and more than 2,000 schools — the first sizing of the next tranche on record, and no commitment or approval date is stated for it. The same account carries the US$150 million programme total that the Bank's own appraisal puts at US$90 million, and nothing on file reconciles the two.

Mauritius

A United Nations development agency published its country annual report for 2025, held in full. It is the agency's own account of its year rather than an independent evaluation, and the digital component is not separately costed in it, so no figure can be lifted from it for this section. What it gives the base is the shape of one external programme against which domestic appropriations can be read.

Morocco

The ministry stated on 22 July that the digital transformation acceleration programme, approved and signed in June 2026, is backed by US$250m over five years, and that bringing it into force before 23 September 2026 was its immediate priority (ministry account). The programme was not in force at 6 August.

A corporate venture fund of US$250m, writing cheques of up to US$5m into regional start-ups, was reported operating on 2 August, the figure attributed by the reporting outlet to a third-party tracker rather than to any Moroccan disclosure (tracker account).

Mozambique

The digital foundations programme runs to 2027 with the European Union delegation funding and the telecommunications union implementing. It reports a national digital skills assessment drawing on more than 30 interviews and a survey of about 400 young people, a Matola pilot training 50 young people and 5 teachers, 15 women trained under a govtech challenge, more than 100 participants in artificial-intelligence training for young women and more than 320 stakeholders reached by accessibility work. The project page is undated and rolling, so none of those outputs can be placed inside this window, and no disbursement update is held.

Nigeria

A US$110m debt facility for technology startups opened for applications on 30 July.

The lending frame around all of it was settled earlier in the summer and its numbers reached the public in two different ways. The World Bank's Executive Directors endorsed the country partnership framework for FY26-FY32 on 29 June and approved a US$1.25bn development policy operation alongside it, whose reform programme includes modernising the regulatory framework for the digital economy and e-governance. The framework itself sets an indicative IDA envelope of about US$5.7bn over the IDA21 period on top of an ongoing programme of over US$16.9bn, and puts its digital commitment as broadband access for more than 58 million Nigerians against a stated baseline of 39% of the population using the internet in 2023 and fixed broadband penetration of 8.4% — and attaches no sum to that target. The sums circulating against it, a US$500m programme for resilient digital infrastructure and a second US$500m pipeline programme, come from a fact sheet handed out at a Lagos forum on 19 August rather than from the framework document, which the newspaper carrying them states on the record. A target with no line against it and a line with no document behind it are different problems, and this month produced one of each.

Rwanda

The month's financing arrived as a parliamentary approval rather than a disbursement. The Chamber of Deputies approved two financing agreements worth a combined Rwf279 billion, funding national strategy measures that include broadband expansion, a labour market information system linking job seekers to employers, and technology for livestock traceability. Three digital lines sit inside one headline number and none of them is separately priced, so the base can record that the money was voted and not what share of it reaches any of the three.

South Africa

One programme opened in the window, and it is not yet a commitment to anybody. On 11 August the United Kingdom published an expression-of-interest call for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m over three years to March 2030, with up to GBP400,000 for 2026/27, covering artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and digital access alongside climate, energy, health and space. South Africa is the primary focus and Zimbabwe and Zambia the first year's. The fund is resourced and the delivery consortium is not chosen, so what the money buys is a matter for a contract expected later in the year.

Tanzania

A Korean development cooperation fund committed US$170m to build an AI and digital technology training institute, approved at its 159th management committee and announced on 23 August 2026 - the fund's first AI project, with the institute to offer four programmes. No site, start date or disbursement schedule is published.

Zambia

On 27 July a domestic digital lender reported more than K500 million lent to over 120,000 customers since founding, and committed a further K500 million over the next decade — a forward intention by the lender itself, with no external financier named.

External money made a smaller and vaguer offer. On 11 August the United Kingdom opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030, naming Zambia with Zimbabwe as the first year's focus and South Africa as the programme's primary one. No Zambian allocation is stated, and the delivery consortium has not been chosen.

Zimbabwe

The ICT minister also committed on 29 July to ring-fencing a share of the universal services fund for public-good artificial-intelligence projects, stating no amount (launch account).

Two external commitments arrived in August, and only one of them has a number attached to Zimbabwe. A United Nations contract award of 10 August puts US$5,947,948 into the supply of ICT equipment to the country — an exact figure against a purpose stated as nothing more than ICT equipment, with neither the receiving government body nor the awarded vendor named. The United Kingdom separately opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030, naming Zimbabwe and Zambia as its first year's focus with South Africa the primary one. No Zimbabwean allocation is stated and no delivery consortium has been chosen.

A third is a conversation. The President met a delegation from an emirate government and a technology company at State House on 8 August to explore a digitisation partnership for aviation and border security, aimed at modernising immigration and border-management systems. Talks only, and no instrument, value, scope or data-protection provision is stated for systems that would process traveller data.

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